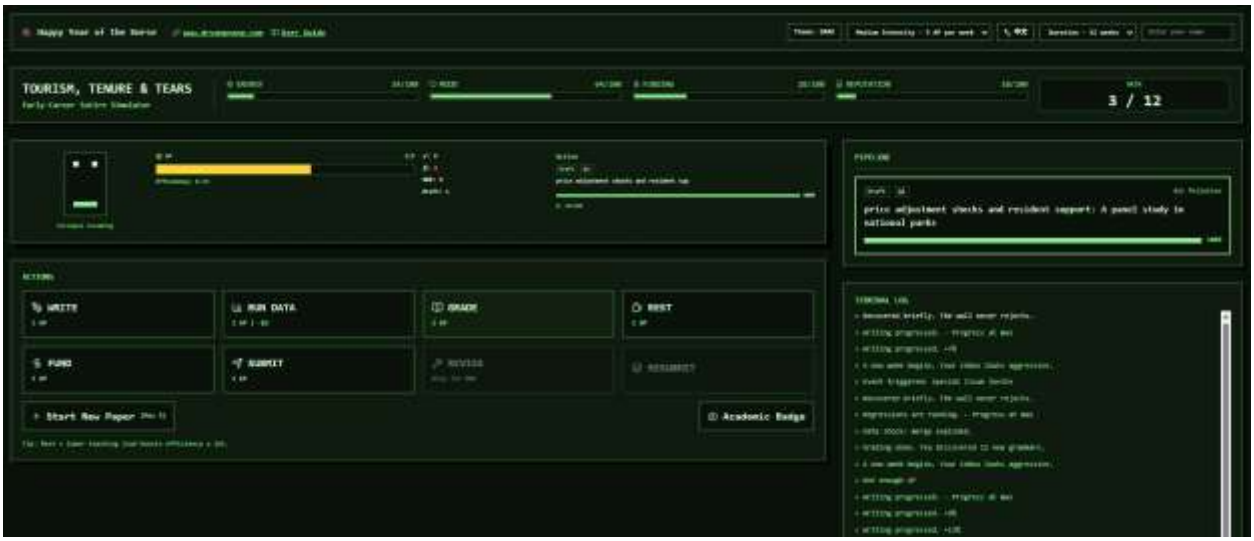
Tourism, Tenure & Tears

Official Survival Guide

Note: the tool is set to display Chinese by default, and you can switch to the English interface easily by clicking the button on the top right:



Chapter 1: Game Overview & Core Philosophy

What is this game?

This is a pixel-style academic career simulator.
You play as an early-career Assistant Professor, trapped inside a brutal 12-week cycle (you can switch to 24-week or 52-week on the top right drop-down menu).

Your mission:
Balance your Energy, Mood, Teaching load, and Funding, while trying to publish as many papers as possible in top-tier journals (especially Q1) to earn that sacred ticket called Tenure.

Core Objective

There is no traditional “victory screen.”
At the end of Week 12, the system evaluates your run based on:

- Number of Accepted papers
- Your final resource status
- Your overall academic survival balance

The algorithm assigns you an Academic Persona:

- 🦄 Rare Unicorn – Multiple acceptances. Fame and glory.
- 🔥 Burnout Engine – Published, but at what cost?
- 🏫 Teaching Hero – No papers, but loved by students.
- 😎 Balanced Survivor – Somehow still functioning.
- 🧂 Salty Realist – Academia as it truly is.

Chapter 2: Getting Started

2.1 Interface Layout

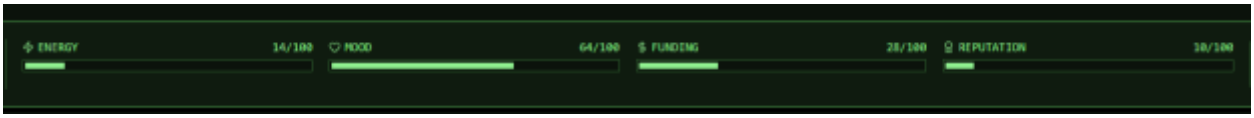
The game uses a minimalist Gameboy-style UI. Mouse or touch only. No keyboard shortcuts.

Top Bar (Header)

Displays:
Week X / 12
This is your academic countdown.

Left Panel (Resources)

Five core attributes:



- Energy
- Mood
- Funding
- Reputation
- Teaching

(See Chapter 3 for detailed mechanics.)

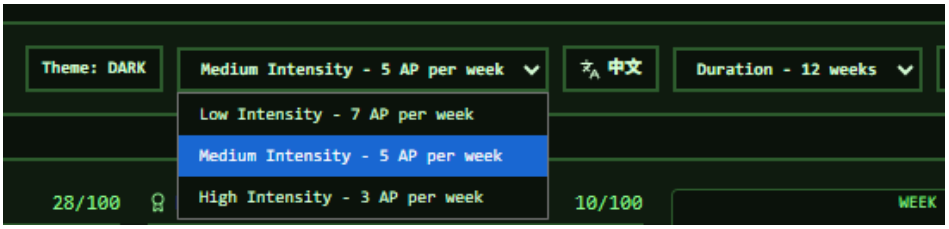
AP Grid (Action Points)

Green blocks represent your AP (Action Points) per week.

Difficulty settings:

- Low Intensity — 7 AP per week
- Medium Intensity — 5 AP per week
- High Intensity — 3 AP per week

Higher difficulty means fewer actions and harsher trade-offs.

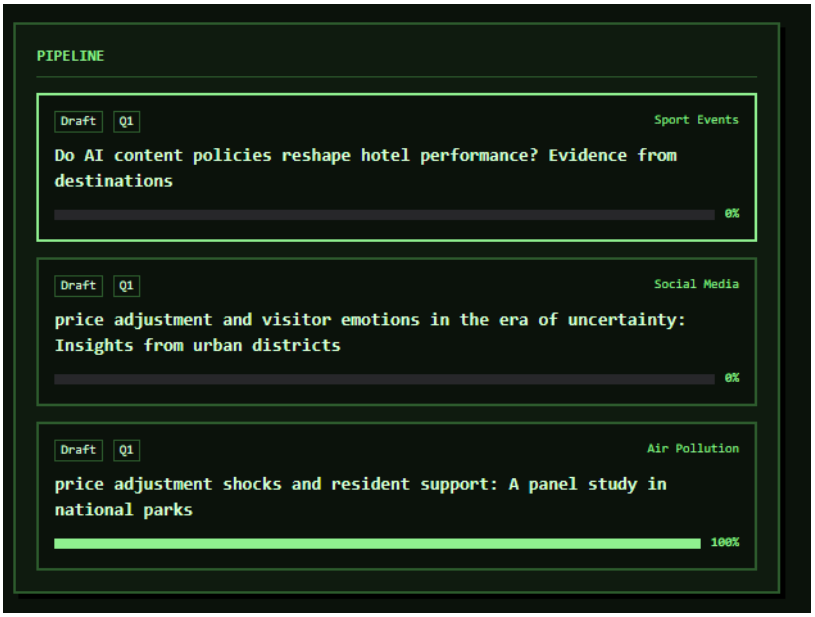


Control Panel (Center)

All actions are performed here:
WRITE, RUN DATA, GRADE, REST, FUND, SUBMIT, REVISE, RESUBMIT.

Pipeline (Right)

Your paper pipeline.
Maximum: 5 papers at the same time.

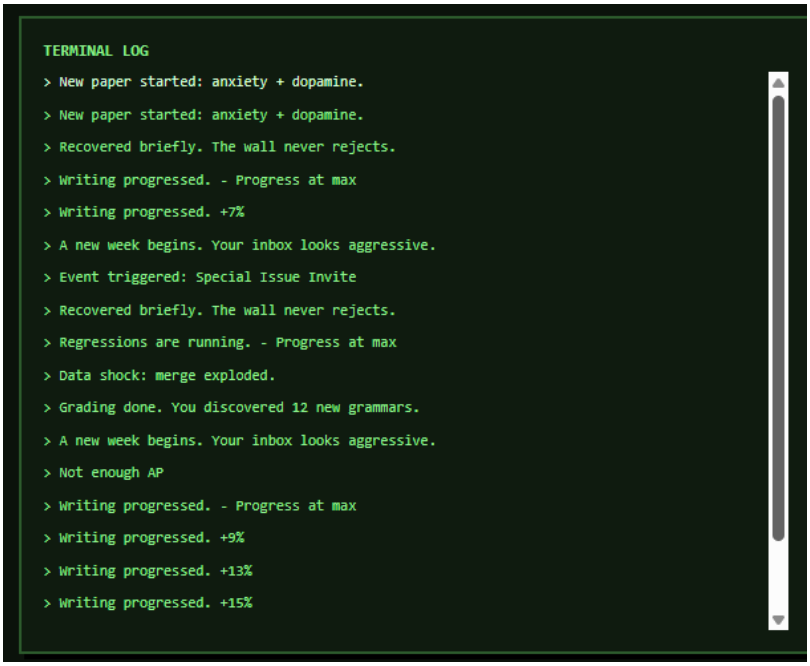


Paper statuses:

- Draft
- Under Review
- R&R
- Accepted
- Rejected

Terminal Log (Bottom)

Read this carefully.
It contains humor, hints, and emotional damage.



2.2 The Weekly Loop

Each week follows this structure:

1. Spend AP — Perform actions.
2. Resource Exchange — Actions modify Energy, Mood, Funding, Teaching, etc.
3. Click END WEEK.
4. Under Review papers advance one week.
5. Random Event may trigger (65% probability).

Repeat until Week 12 (or 24, 52).

Chapter 3: Survival Mechanics & Resource Management

Managing resources is more important than writing.

3.1 Energy — The Core Resource

Represents physical and mental stamina.

Efficiency Thresholds

- Energy ≥ 60 → 1.15× efficiency bonus
- 35–59 → Normal efficiency
- 20–34 → 0.85× efficiency
- < 20 → 0.70× efficiency (low-power mode)
- < 18 → Collapse incoming (quality penalty)

If Energy is too low:

- Writing becomes inefficient
- Paper Quality decreases
- Revision slows down

Recovery:
Use **REST**, but high Teaching reduces recovery.

3.2 Mood — The Invisible Killer

Represents psychological stability.

Mood decreases from:

- Rejections
- Student complaints
- Failed grant applications

If Mood < 25 during **REVISE**, revision efficiency is penalized.

Very low Mood may push you toward collapse.

3.3 Funding — Fuel for RUN DATA

You cannot use **RUN DATA** if Funding < 2.

RUN DATA:

- Faster progress
- Higher Quality gain
- 22% chance of “Merge Exploded” (Data Shock)

Funding is obtained through **FUND**.

High Reputation increases grant success probability.

3.4 Reputation — The Matthew Effect

Increases:

- Acceptance probability
- Grant success rate
- Review turnaround speed

Earned mainly through:

- Accepted papers
- Academic events

Low Reputation makes Q1 extremely risky.

3.5 Teaching

Higher Teaching:

- Reduces writing efficiency
- Reduces paper Quality

- Weakens REST recovery

Use **GRADE** to reduce Teaching pressure.

Chapter 4: Core Actions Explained

WRITE

- Cost: 1 AP, 12 Energy, 2 Mood
- Gain: Paper Progress
- Teaching +2

Best when Funding is low.

RUN DATA

- Cost: 1 AP, 10 Energy, 2 Funding, 2 Mood
- Gain: High Progress + High Quality
- 22% Data Shock risk

Best efficiency strategy if funded.

GRADE

- Cost: 1 AP, 10 Energy, 1 Mood
- Teaching −14

Defensive action.

REST

- Cost: 1 AP
- Restores Energy and Mood (reduced if Teaching high)

Critical for maintaining efficiency bonus.

FUND

- Cost: 1 AP, 6 Energy
- Success probability depends on Reputation & Energy
- Success → +14 Funding
- Failure → Mood −5

High risk early-game.

Chapter 5: Submission & Review System

SUBMIT

Requirements:

- Status: Draft
- Progress ≥ 100%

System generates:

- Reviewer types
- Revise points
- ETA (1–2 weeks)

Paper becomes **Under Review**.

REVISE

Only available during **R&R**.

Each REVISE:

- Consumes AP

- Reduces Revise Points
- Affected by Energy & Mood

When Revise Points = 0:

- Auto resubmission
- Round 2 begins

RESUBMIT

Available after **Rejected**.

Returns paper to Draft:

- Progress ≈ 82% retained
- Quality slightly reduced

Never abandon a rejected paper.

Chapter 6: Hidden Mechanics

Efficiency Formula

Efficiency depends on:

- Energy
- Teaching penalty
- Mood penalty

Keep Energy ≥ 60 whenever possible.

Quality Calculation

Quality determines acceptance.

Affected by:

- Progress overflow bonus

- Teaching penalty
- Low Energy penalty

Never submit under high Teaching load.

Reviewer Types

Possible reviewers include:

- Methodology Freak
- Theory Purist
- Citation Hoarder
- Three-Line Rejector
- Writing Coach
- Misreader
- Rare Nice Reviewer
- One-Method Evangelist

Pray for Rare Nice Reviewer.

Decision Logic

Acceptance probability:

(Quality + Reputation × 0.25 − Journal Difficulty + Round Bonus) / 140

Journal difficulty:

- Q1: 72
- Q2: 52
- Q3: 34

Round 2 gets +6 bonus.

Strategy:
Low Reputation → Avoid Q1 early.

Chapter 7: FAQ

Why is my paper stuck in Under Review?

Check: “Decision in X weeks.”
You cannot act on it during review.
Start a new paper or apply for funding.

What is Student Complaint?

Random event. Choose wisely:

- Pull all-nighter → Lose Energy, save Reputation
- Explain politely → Lose Mood
- Ignore → Teaching explodes

How to achieve Rare Unicorn?

- At least 2 Accepted papers
- High efficiency early
- Smart R&R management
- Avoid Methodology Freak

Why does RUN DATA sometimes fail?

You triggered “Merge Exploded.”
22% probability.

Academia simulation = realistic suffering.

Good luck.
May Reviewer 2 be merciful.